Seranai

OpenFOS

Open Founder Operating System

TAM SAM SOM Calculator

24 Skills + 2 Reference Modules
Organized by FOUNDRY Framework

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What Is This Skill?

The TAM + SAM + SOM Calculator is an AI-powered tool that helps you answer one of the most important questions any investor will ask: How big is the market? It goes further than most tools by giving you three distinct numbers — each one sharper and more actionable than the last.

It works as a conversation. You describe your startup idea, who you're selling to, and where — and the skill guides you step by step through estimating your Total Addressable Market, Serviceable Addressable Market, and Serviceable Obtainable Market. No spreadsheets, no MBA jargon, no guesswork.

THE CORE PRINCIPLE

Every number in your market sizing must come from you — or from a source you've reviewed and approved. The skill never assumes. That's what makes the output investor-grade.

By the end of one conversation (about 20 minutes), you will have a fully calculated TAM, SAM, and SOM — each with a clear methodology, a plain-English explanation of what the numbers mean, and a sanity check that stress-tests your assumptions.

Who Is This For?

This skill is designed for founders who have validated their problem and are ready to size the opportunity — before pitching investors, before building a financial model, and before deciding where to compete first. It is especially useful if:

- You've validated your problem and want to know if the market is worth pursuing
- You're preparing for investor conversations and need credible market size numbers
- You're deciding between multiple segments and want to size each one objectively
- You're a first-time founder who has never done market sizing before
- You want to know what you can realistically win in Year 1, not just the theoretical ceiling
- You're in an emerging market and need a framework that works without published research

This skill works for founders anywhere in the world. Whether you are in Lagos, Dubai, Bangalore, São Paulo, or San Francisco, the methodology adapts to your market context and available data.

How to Get Started

Using this skill requires three things: access to Claude (claude.ai or the Claude app), the TAM-SAM-SOM skill installed, and your idea described in your own words.

Step 1: Open Claude and Start a New Conversation

Go to claude.ai or open the Claude app. Start a new conversation. That's it.

Step 2: Describe Your Idea

Tell Claude what your product does, who your customer is, and where you are selling. You don't need perfect numbers to start — rough estimates are explicitly encouraged. The skill will ask follow-up questions for anything that's missing.

Examples of Great Starting Messages:

EXAMPLE 1 — Detailed

"I'm building a compliance monitoring tool for fintech startups in Southeast Asia. Customers are roughly 2,000 licensed fintechs across the region. I'm thinking of charging $600/month. My team is 3 salespeople."

EXAMPLE 2 — Brief

"Invoice management SaaS for freelance designers in India. I think there are around 500,000 active freelancers. Pricing around ₹1,500/month."

EXAMPLE 3 — Minimal

"Inventory management for small grocery stores in Nigeria."

All three of these will work. The more detail you provide, the faster you'll reach your first number. But even a single sentence is enough — the skill will ask only for what's genuinely missing.

Step 3: Follow the Conversation

The skill guides you through four phases. You don't need to prepare anything in advance or remember any steps. Just respond naturally to the questions it asks. The whole process takes about 20 minutes.

What Happens: The Four Phases

The skill walks you through four phases, each building on the last. Here's what to expect at each stage.

PHASE 1: CONTEXT GATHERING Your product, customer, and geography locked in • ~2 minutes	
What You Do	• Describe your product in one sentence • Name your target customer and where you're selling
What You Get	• Your business restated clearly in founder language • Confirmation of what the skill already knows vs. what it still needs • A fast-path check: if you already have a rough customer count and price, you skip straight to calculation

WHY THIS MATTERS:

The skill never asks for information you've already provided. If your price, location, or customer type appears anywhere in the conversation, it carries that forward without asking again. This keeps the process fast and respectful of your time.

PHASE 2: TAM APPROACH SELECTION

Choosing the right method for your market • ~3 minutes

What You Do	• Answer 1–2 questions about what data is available for your market • Confirm or provide your customer count and annual price per customer
What You Get	• The best calculation approach for your specific business (Bottom-Up, Top-Down, Value Theory, Competitor-Based, or Government Data) • Where possible, two approaches used in parallel — two methods pointing to the same number is far more convincing to investors • Your Total Addressable Market (TAM) calculated step by step, with every input visible

PHASE 3: SAM CALCULATION

Narrowing to what you can actually reach • ~5 minutes

What You Do	• Confirm the geography or segment you are launching in first • Approve any filter percentages used to narrow TAM to SAM — each one is shown to you before being applied
What You Get	• Your Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM) with a clear breakdown of every filter applied • An explanation of what SAM means for your specific business — who is in it, who isn't, and why • A sanity check that flags if SAM looks too large (overreach) or too small (over-filtering)

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PHASE 4: SOM + FULL MARKET PICTURE Your realistic Year 1–3 revenue target • ~5 minutes to read	
What You Do	• Provide your team size and sales capacity, marketing budget, or warm pipeline • Confirm your time horizon (Year 1 / Year 2 / Year 3)
What You Get	• Your Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM) — the number you can actually hit • The complete TAM + SAM + SOM summary in one clear view • Plain-English explanation of all three numbers together • A bridge to the next skill in the sequence (Market & Beachhead)

Understanding Your Results

The Three Numbers — and What They Actually Mean

Most founders know they need TAM, SAM, and SOM for investor decks. Fewer understand what the numbers actually represent — or why getting them wrong is worse than not having them at all.

TAM	SAM	SOM
Total Addressable Market **The whole pie.** If every possible customer in the world bought from you — what is the total revenue? This is a ceiling, not a target.	**Serviceable Addressable Market** **Your realistic slice.** Of the whole pie, how much can you actually reach right now? Filtered by geography, segment, affordability, and tech requirements.	**Serviceable Obtainable Market** **What you can win.** Of your realistic slice, how much can you realistically capture in the next 1–3 years given your team, budget, and pipeline?

The Five TAM Calculation Approaches

The skill selects the best approach for your business automatically — but you can always ask to use two approaches in parallel for stronger credibility.

Approach	Best When...	How It Works
Bottom-Up	You know customer count and price	Customers × yearly price = TAM
Top-Down	Your industry has published research	Industry total × your relevant portion = TAM
Value Theory	Your product saves measurable time or money	Value saved × % they'd pay × customer count = TAM

Competitor-Based	Competitors exist with known revenue	Competitor revenue ÷ estimated market share = TAM
Government Data	Customers are registered or tracked entities	Official count × yearly price = TAM

The Six SAM Filtering Approaches

SAM is calculated by applying one or more filters to your TAM. The skill stacks as many filters as apply to your business — the more specific, the more credible your SAM becomes.

Approach	What It Filters	Use When...
Targeted Filtering	Geography + customer type + price combined	Founder can describe their specific target across multiple dimensions
Geographic Narrowing	Region or country only	You are launching in one market first and the rest of TAM is not reachable yet
Channel-Based	Reachability through one channel	You are selling exclusively through one app, marketplace, or referral network
Regulatory Filtering	Legal eligibility	Some customers in your TAM are off-limits by law or licensing rules
Technology Filtering	Infrastructure requirements	Your product requires specific tech (smartphone, internet, POS system, etc.)
Affordability Filtering	Who can actually pay	Your price excludes a meaningful portion of the TAM

The Five SOM Calculation Approaches

SOM is calculated from your confirmed SAM using one of five approaches depending on what you know about your team, budget, and pipeline. The skill aims to use two approaches wherever possible — two methods landing on a similar number is far more convincing to investors.

Approach	Best When...	How It Works
Market Share Estimate	You have a % of SAM in mind	SAM × your realistic market share % = SOM
Sales Capacity	You know your team size and close rate	(Salespeople × deals/month × months) × yearly revenue per customer = SOM
Competitor Benchmarking	Competitors have known early-stage revenue	Comparable competitor Year 1–3 revenue × your adjustment factor = SOM
Budget-Based	You have a defined sales or marketing budget	(Budget ÷ cost to acquire one customer) × yearly revenue per customer = SOM

Pipeline-Based	You have a list of warm leads or early prospects	(Pipeline count × conversion %) × yearly revenue per customer = SOM

Reading the SOM Sanity Check

After calculating your SOM, the skill automatically checks whether the number is realistic. Here's what each signal means:

⚠️ SOM > 20% of SAM in Year 1	✅ SOM is 1–10% of SAM	ℹ️ SOM < 1% of SAM
Ambitious	**Credible**	**Conservative**
Bold target — exciting ambition, but investors will push back hard. Be ready to prove your team and budget can execute at that pace.	This is the investor sweet spot. Conservative enough to be believable, large enough to be interesting. Year 2 and Year 3 growth tells the full story.	Often smart in Year 1. Are there ways to grow the pipeline or add sales capacity that could stretch the number over 2–3 years?

Tips for Getting the Most Out of This Skill

Use rough numbers — that's the point. The skill is built to work with approximations. "About 5,000 customers" is enough to calculate TAM. "Around $500/month" is enough to start. You don't need precise data to get a credible market size — you need honest estimates you can defend.

"I don't know" moves you forward, not backward. If you don't know your customer count, the skill will search for it and show you the source before using it. If you don't know your close rate, it will suggest a reasonable benchmark and ask if it sounds right. Uncertainty is data — it tells you what to research next.

Run it for each segment you're considering. If you're choosing between targeting enterprise vs. SMB, or one country vs. another, run a separate calculation for each. The contrast between market sizes is often more revealing than any single number.

Push for two approaches. If the skill calculates TAM using one method, ask it to run a second approach as a sanity check. Two independent approaches pointing to the same ballpark figure is the gold standard for investor conversations.

Show the work, not just the number. Investors don't just want to see '$4B TAM.' They want to see the logic: how many customers, at what price, in what geography. The skill's output format gives you exactly this — don't strip out the methodology when you present it.

Come back as your assumptions change. Market sizing is not a one-time exercise. As you talk to customers and learn more about your segment, rerun the calculation with updated inputs. A market size that evolves with evidence is a sign of a rigorous founder.

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I need to have done Problem Validation first?

Not strictly. But if you haven't validated your problem yet, the market size numbers may be misleading — you could be sizing a market for a problem nobody actually has. Skill 1 (Problem Validation) takes 15 minutes and makes everything in this skill sharper.

What if I don't know how many customers are in my market?

That's fine and common. The skill will search for an estimate, show you the source and year, and ask if it looks right before using it. If no reliable data exists, it will guide you to build a bottom-up estimate from what you do know.

How is this different from just Googling "market size for X"?

A Google search gives you a single top-down figure from a research report — often for a market broader than yours. This skill builds a number specific to your product, your customer, your geography, and your price point. It also gives you SAM and SOM, which Google never will.

Can I use this for B2C businesses?

The skill is optimized for B2B, where pricing, customer counts, and sales capacity are easier to estimate. A B2C version that accounts for consumer volume, conversion funnels, and viral growth dynamics is on the roadmap.

What if my SOM looks very small?

Small SOM is often the right answer in Year 1 — focus beats dilution. The skill will help you understand whether the SOM is constrained by team size (solvable by hiring), geography (solvable by expansion), or market readiness (the harder constraint). Understanding which it is changes your strategy.

How long does it take?

About 20 minutes for the full TAM + SAM + SOM conversation. Faster if you already have your customer count and price. Longer if you need to discuss approach selection or research data sources together.

Is my data private?

Your conversation is between you and Claude. The skill does not store or share your business details with anyone.

The FOUNDRY Framework

FOUNDRY is the sequential journey framework that guides founders from initial idea through scale or exit. Each letter represents a stage, and each stage contains specific skills a founder needs to master.

Stage	Purpose	Skills
F – Foundation	Validate the idea. Confirm the problem is real, the market exists, and you know who to serve.	Skills 1–4
O – Outline	Design the business. Articulate value, map competition, model revenue, scope the MVP.	Skills 5–8
U – User	Acquire and understand customers. Discover needs, design GTM, set pricing, run experiments.	Skills 9–12
N – Nurture	Build relationships and traction. Craft the pitch, model financials, build the founder narrative.	Skills 13–15
D – Discipline	Execute and operate. Set OKRs, hire the team, handle legal and entity setup.	Skills 16–18
R – Results	Measure and iterate. Track KPIs, assess PMF, decide whether to pivot or persevere.	Skills 19–20
Y – Yield	Scale or exit. Confirm scaling readiness, plan liquidity events.	Skills 21–22

Cross-cutting skills (23–24) are not stage-specific and can be invoked at any point in the journey.

Reference modules (R1–R2) are shared evaluation lenses that multiple skills invoke. They are never used in isolation.